

THE MAN IN THE RED BANDANA

Blue denotes power point slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

Jude 1:22-23 (KJV) *“Of some have compassion, making a difference:*

²³And others save with fear, pulling them out of the fire; hating even the garment spotted by the flesh.”

Anyone who was alive on September 11, 2001 remembers where they were and what they were doing when they learned that radical religious madmen had flown two airliners into the World Trade Center, one into the Pentagon, and one into the ground in Pennsylvania. On that infamous day:

- 2,735 civilians died in the World Trade Center...
- 87 Passengers and crew aboard American Airlines Flight 111 perished...
- 60 passengers and crew aboard Delta flight 175 left this earth...
- 125 people in the Pentagon died...
- 64 passengers aboard American Airlines Flight 77 were killed...
- 36 brave passengers aboard United Flight 93 gave up their lives over Pennsylvania, probably preventing a tragedy that would have ended at the White House...

- 23 New York City law enforcement officers; 37 Port Authority police officers; 47 Port Authority workers; and 343 New York City firefighters and rescue workers were killed in the rescue effort...

All total 3,557 rescue workers and citizens stepped into eternity on that horrific day! In addition 19 radical religious cowards went to hell in their plan, driven by hatred toward innocent people!

Inside the World Trade Center, a horrific scene developed as a group of individuals sat bloody and terrified -- the lights out, smoke engulfing the room and pain searing through their bodies. As far as they knew, there was no escape from where they were in the South Tower. The room they were in lay in pieces after being hit by Delta Flight 175.

(PLACE THE GRAPHIC AND THE TITLE OF THE SERMON ON THE SCREEN AT THIS TIME)

Then out of nowhere, a young man wearing a red bandana burst in and took control. In a strong, authoritative voice, he let them know he had discovered an obscure stairway. He led them through the darkness, over the wreckage and down the stairwell, all the while, instructing the healthy to assist the injured.

Judy Wein who was trapped in the building later stated, *"I saw this incredible hero, running back and forth and saving the day, in his mind, he had a duty to do -- to save people."*

(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)

You are in this meeting today because you are urgent with regard to reaching the lost! STL has been responsible for reaching tens of thousands of souls, depopulating hell and populating heaven.

The man in the red bandana was obviously driven by a sense of urgency. He knew a lot of people were going to perish and time meant lives!

I want to say how much I appreciate those of you who consistently give to missions, because time means souls. You are in this meeting today because you are actively and passionately engaged in the people business!

Urgency must be the order of the day because we are running short on three very precious commodities:

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Money...
- People...
- Time...

(My story about the Juarez city dump – *“I did not call you to be a missionary, I called you to build a great missions church.”*)

The heartbeat of God is the salvation of the lost: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- The duty of the Church is reaching the lost...
- The responsibility of the Church is reaching the lost...
- The business of the Church is reaching the lost...
- The activity of the Church is reaching the lost...
- The privilege of the Church is reaching the lost...
- The joy of the Church is reaching the lost...
- The reward of the Church is reaching the lost...

In a little while we are going to raise the funds to purchase an automobile for a Missionary, and I want you to remember that this has nothing to do with an automobile, it has everything to do with souls. If we send a missionary to a mission field and do not provide transportation, we greatly reduce their effectiveness and that means a loss of souls! Please view this offering as souls, rather than wheels!

Ling Young, one of the survivors rescued by the man in the red bandana said, *"He's definitely my guardian angel -- no ifs, ands, or buts -- because without him, we would be*

sitting there, waiting until the building came down,"
**(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT
SLIDE)**

A few minutes and a few floors separated Judy Wein and Ling Young that day, but they share a similar story and a single hero. It was not until the spring of 2002 that the New York Times ran a story on the man in the red bandana and it was revealed that he was in fact, Welles Crowther.

Judy Wein was working for the insurance firm AON Corporation located one floor below Welles' office when American Airlines Flight 111 hit the adjacent North Tower. Ignoring an announcement telling her building's occupants to stay put, she began heading downstairs.

Ling Young, who was in her 86th floor office of New York's Department of Taxation and Finance, took an elevator to the 78th floor sky lobby. She was waiting there to board an express elevator to the street when the United jet tore through the floor, sending a rush of flames and debris that knocked her to the ground.

When she got up and cleared the blood -- her blood -- from her glasses, Young said she saw "*nobody -- almost everyone was dead.*" After a little time, she discovered

there were a handful of survivors and they decided to huddle together and wait for help.

After several grueling minutes, Welles, who had already made several trips, rescuing survivors popped onto the floor and announced that he had found a staircase they could use to escape. Badly burned, Young and her fellow survivors obediently followed Welles, who was carrying a young black woman on his back.

He left the survivors in the hands of some other rescuers 15 floors later and headed back upstairs, according to Young, saying, *“More people needed assistance.”*

When he returned to the 78th floor, Wein was waiting in pain, the impact having broken her arm, cracked her ribs and puncturing a lung.

Welles burst into the room and, as he had with Young's group, loudly and calmly directed people to the stairs. This time, Welles went his own way as Wein headed down the stairs. She stated, *"If he hadn't come back, I wouldn't have made it,"* She continued, *“People can live 100 years and not have the compassion, the wherewithal to do what he did.”* **(PLACE BOTH OF THESE QUOTES ON THE SCREEN AT THE SAME TIME AND LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)**

Welles Crowther was born the oldest of three children, his parents say. *“He followed his father Jefferson's lead, always carrying a bandanna in his back pocket and joining him as a volunteer firefighter as a teenager.”*

A star student and lacrosse player at Boston College, Welles joined Sandler O'Neil and Partners after graduation. His firm was located on the 104th floor of the South Tower of the World Trade Center in New York City, and that is where he was on September 11th, 2001.

While he loved his job, Welles told his dad that he really wanted to join the New York City Fire Department -- or possibly the CIA or FBI -- so he wouldn't be stuck behind a desk and would be able to help others.

Welles made one final call to his mother Allison from his office at 9:12 a.m., minutes after his tower was struck, leaving a brief, calm message saying, *"Mom, this is Welles. I want you to know that I'm OK."*

That call was all the Crowther's knew about their son's final moments until police knocked on their door months later. Allison said the New York medical examiner's office told them *“Welles' body had been found intact, with no signs of burns, alongside firefighters and emergency*

workers who had been running a command center in the South Tower's lobby and they were killed as the building collapsed.” (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)

Authorities speculated, according to Allison, that Welles was aiding the rescue effort as a civilian volunteer usher when he died.

Welles could have:

- Looked out for himself and let everyone else do the same...
- Rescued the first group of people and taken himself to safety as well...
- Ceased the pattern of rescue after he led his second group of people to safety, and still have been considered a hero...

He did nothing of the sort! He worked in the business of rescue until he died. There is no discharge in this business of rescue!

Rescue is the constant pattern of Gods activity! (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE) What we are doing here today is not about automobiles or wheels it's about rescue!

The only fulfillment in life is in Christ and doing His will – rescuing the perishing and caring for the dying is the highest order and privilege of man! What you are about to do here today is not really about STL, Missionaries, vehicles, or equipment, it's about a rescue effort!

Judy Wein, one of the ladies rescued by Welles stated, *“I wouldn't have made it if it had not been for the assistance provided by Welles.”*

There are souls who will be eternally lost if we do not step up to the plate today and continue doing our part to rescue them!

A life of action produces a legacy of achievement!

(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE) Those of you who are fully engaged in giving to missions and fulfilling the Great Commission on a personal level are creating a legacy of:

- Rescue...
- Kindness...
- Obedience...
- Compassion...
- Eternal life...

(Story of J.C. Mitchell)

Jude the half-brother of Jesus viewed the work of evangelism in the same way Welles viewed the rescue effort on that infamous day in September of 2001! Jude 1:22-23 (KJV) *“Of some have compassion, making a difference:*

²³And others save with fear, pulling them out of the fire; hating even the garment spotted by the flesh.” Jude describes the work of evangelism with words like:

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Have compassion...
- Make a difference...
- Save with fear...
- Pull them out of the fire...
- Hate the garment spotted by the flesh...

(Story of Larry Collins' house on fire – Daughter Sherry)

Who are you personally involved with for the expressed purpose of rescue? The constant activity of God is rescue! Is that the consistent pattern of our:

- Personal life?
- Professional life?
- Ministry life?
- Church life?

Just being involved in rescue through gifts to missions is not enough, we must be in the state of personal rescue at all times! Money, people and time are of the essence.

CONCLUSION:

Karen Watson, a missionary who was martyred in Iraq in 2004 wrote a last letter to be read in the event of her death. It was read at her funeral. This was her letter:

Dear Pastor,

You should only be opening this letter in the event of my death. When God calls there are no regrets. I tried to share my heart with you as much as possible, my heart for the nations. I wasn't called to a place; I was called to Him. To obey was my objective, to suffer was expected, His glory my reward, His glory my reward...

The missionary heart: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME – LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE)

- Cares more than some think is wise...
- Risks more than some think is safe...
- Dreams more than some think is practical...
- Expects more than some think is possible...

I was called not to comfort or to success but to obedience...
There is no Joy outside of knowing Jesus and serving Him.
I love you and my church family.

In His care,
Karen Watson

If Welles gave his life to rescue total strangers and Karen deposited her blood on Iraqi soil to save people who ultimately killed her, do you think we could buy a car for this Missionary today?